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By [Darren Gibbs](#)
Senior Economist NZ

06:30 March 06 2026

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A two-minute video update on the New Zealand economy and markets from Senior Economist Darren Gibbs.

Middle East conflict puts upward pressure on petrol prices

Renewed conflict in the Middle East poses near-term upside risks to inflation. The RBNZ will look through a temporary inflation spike, but a more complex policy dilemma may occur if the conflict is prolonged.

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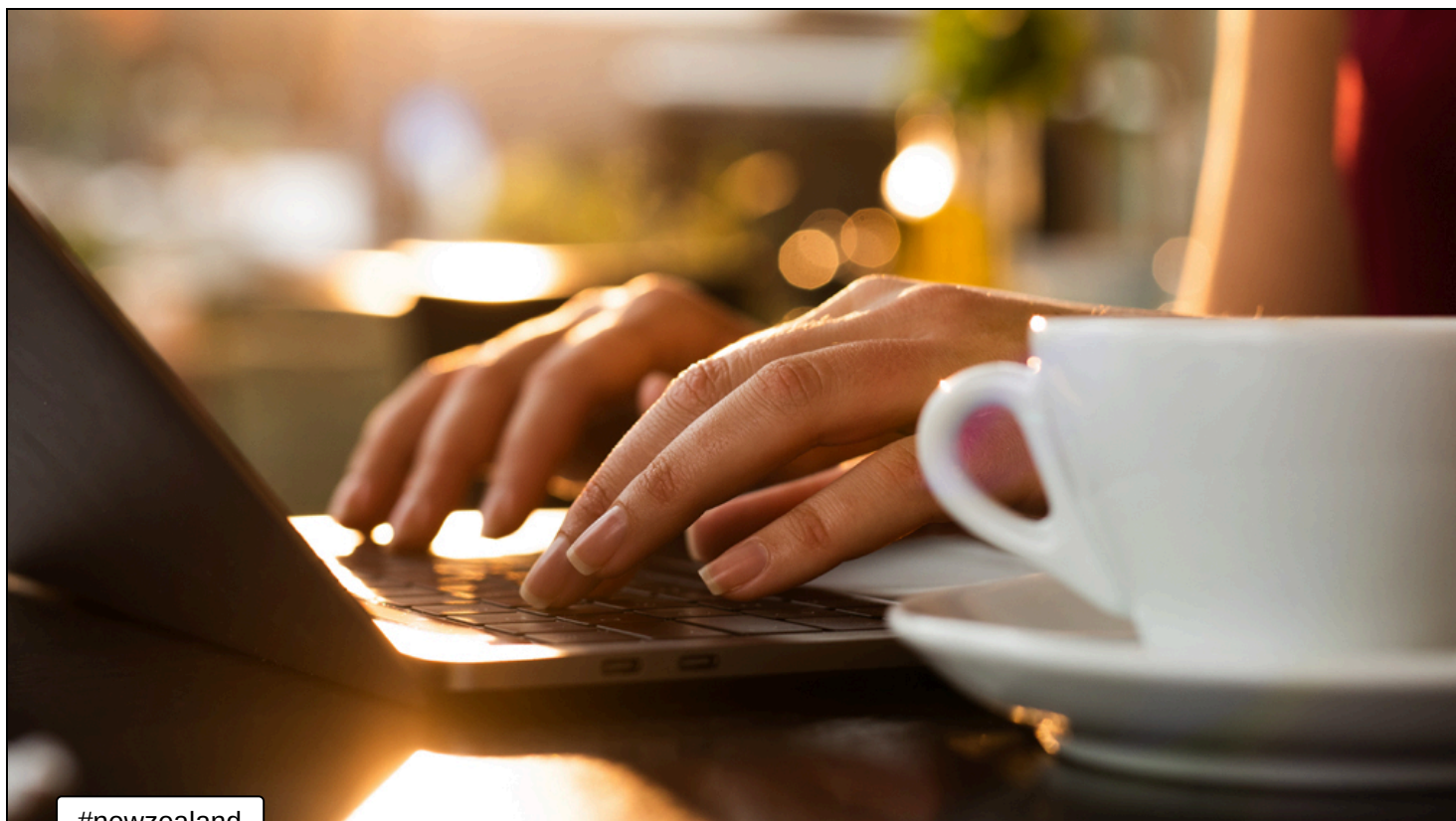
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